

DHA 2026 Ad Rules

What Dubai Clinics Can and Can't Say

DHA 2026 Ad Rules: What Dubai Clinics Can and Can't Say

What changed

On **17 August 2026**, the Dubai Health Authority sent circular **CIR-2026-00000144** to every private health facility and healthcare professional in Dubai.

It puts the **Standards for Medical Advertisement Content on Social Media** into force and warns that not following them can lead to disciplinary action.

Who it covers:

DHA-licensed clinics, hospitals and practitioners, plus anyone promoting them: influencers, doctors posting on personal accounts, and admin staff.

Where it applies:

Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, YouTube, Snapchat, WhatsApp and LinkedIn - so every Meta ad, boosted post, reel and WhatsApp broadcast your clinic runs.

Why it matters now :

most clinic ads in Dubai were written before this circular. If yours say "the best," show edited before-and-after photos, or feature an influencer nobody approved, they need fixing.

This guide turns the standard into checklists you can run through in 15 minutes. It's written for dental and aesthetic clinics, but the rules apply to every specialty.



Words you can't use, and what to say instead

The standard bans absolute and exaggerated claims. These are the words named in it:

unique · one of a kind · the best · exclusive · safest · the only · incomparable · unprecedented · magic · miraculous · assured success · very limited quantity · no side effects · 100% · absolutely certain · distinguished · famous · pioneer · immediate results

It also rules out promising full recovery, saying a treatment always works, claiming a doctor has a unique skill, or saying you're better or safer than another clinic or doctor.

Instead of	Say something like
"The best dental clinic in Dubai"	"Dental clinic in [area], open 7 days"
"100% painless implants"	"Implants under local anaesthetic - we explain what to expect at your consultation"
"Immediate results whitening"	"Professional whitening in one visit. Results vary by person."
"Safest Botox in Dubai"	"Botox by DHA-licensed doctors"
"No side effects"	"Your doctor will explain benefits and possible side effects first"
"Only clinic offering [machine]"	"Now offering [treatment] with [machine]"
"Famous / pioneer doctor"	"Dr [Name], [title exactly as on DHA licence], [year] years' experience"
"Limited slots - book now!"	"Book your consultation" (only mention limits if they're real)
"Guaranteed perfect smile"	"A smile plan designed around your teeth"

Two more traps:

- **Titles.** Use the exact title on the DHA licence. "Cosmetic Specialist," "Aesthetic Consultant," "Aesthetician" and "Cosmetologist" are not allowed unless that's what the licence says. "Dr" is only for physicians, dentists and recognised doctorates.
- **Prices and offers.** Every price needs its conditions stated. No time-limited deals you can't actually honour.

Before-and-after photos and patient consent

Before-and-after photos are still allowed, but only if every box below is ticked. If any one isn't, take the post down or fix it.

- ☐ Same patient in both photos
- ☐ Same lens and camera setup for both
- ☐ No Photoshop, filters, face-tune or equivalent editing
- ☐ A disclaimer that results aren't guaranteed and vary from person to person
- ☐ The main risks of the treatment are mentioned
- ☐ Disclaimer text is the same size as the rest of the ad - not tiny print
- ☐ Written consent from the patient, on file
- ☐ Consent covers this specific use and time period, not "any marketing forever"
- ☐ For anyone under 18: written consent from a parent

The same consent rule applies to patient videos, reviews and testimonials.

A WhatsApp "sure, you can post it" is risky - get it in writing on a consent form.

Never film or livestream a patient during surgery under general anaesthesia for marketing.



Sign-off, staff and influencers

The **medical director is accountable** for every ad that promotes the clinic - including posts on accounts the clinic doesn't own.

Approvals

- ☐ Every ad and post naming the clinic is approved by the medical director before it goes live
- ☐ Influencer, doctor and staff posts that name or tag the clinic go through the same approval
- ☐ Anything filmed inside the clinic is treated as the clinic's responsibility, even if a patient or influencer posts it

Accounts

- ☐ The clinic's official accounts show its MOHAP medical advertisement licence number
- ☐ Doctors keep separate professional and personal accounts, and don't engage patients from personal ones
- ☐ A trained person is named to moderate comments and messages

Training and records

- ☐ Staff are trained on these rules at induction, with regular refreshers
- ☐ Staff have been told the penalties for breaking them
- ☐ Every ad and post is archived with its edits, ready for a DHA audit

Quick tip: a shared Google Drive folder with one sub-folder per month - ad copy, image, approval message, date live - covers the approval and archive boxes in one go.



Two ads, rewritten

Compliant doesn't mean boring. These ads still give people a clear reason to book - they just swap promises for facts.

1. Dental implants

✗ Dubai's BEST implant clinic! 100% painless, guaranteed results, only AED 2,999 - limited slots, book now!

✓ Missing a tooth? Implant consultations with DHA-licensed dentists in [area]. We take a 3D scan, explain your options, risks and total cost up front. From AED [X] - final price depends on your treatment plan. Book your consultation.

What changed: no "best," "100%" or "guaranteed"; the price has its condition; the fake scarcity is gone. The process (scan, options, upfront cost) does the selling instead.

2. Aesthetic injectables

✗ Our famous aesthetic specialist gives magical results - see this before & after! No down time, no side effects.

✓ Anti-wrinkle treatment with Dr [Name], [exact DHA licence title]. Un edited before-and-after, shared with patient consent. Results vary by person; possible side effects include bruising and swelling. Book a consultation to see if it's right for you.

What changed: licence title instead of "specialist"; the photo is labelled unedited and consented; the disclaimer and risks are in the main text, not hidden.

Is your agency/marketing team up to date?

If someone else runs your ads, ask them these questions this week. You should get a clear "yes" to each.

- ☐ Have you checked all our live ads against the **August 2026 DHA standards**?
- ☐ Do you send every ad to our **medical director for approval** before it goes live?
- ☐ Do you keep a record of every ad, with the approval, that we can show DHA?
- ☐ Are our before-and-after images unedited, with consent forms on file?
- ☐ Do our influencer and doctor posts go through the same approval?
- ☐ Is our MOHAP advertisement licence number on our official accounts?
- ☐ Do we **own our ad accounts**, and can I log in and see them myself?

That last one matters more than it looks. If your agency set the accounts up under its own name, you may not be able to see your own ads, spend or results - and **you'd lose all that history** if you ever moved. Ask to be made an admin on your **Google Ads and Meta accounts**.



Want a second pair of eyes?



Send us your clinic/healthcare sector name on WhatsApp. We'll check your live Meta and Google ads against these rules and send back what would need changing - usually within 24 hours.

You don't need to give us access to anything. Your ads are already public, so we just look at what patients see.

WhatsApp: +971 50 139 0421 • Website: advibeagency.me

Advibe Agency FZ-LLC - Google & Meta Ads for UAE clinics

This guide summarises the DHA Standards for Medical Advertisement Content on Social Media (circular CIR-2026-00000144, 17 August 2026) for marketing purposes. It is not legal advice. Your medical director and the relevant health authority have the final say on what your clinic publishes. Clinics licensed in Abu Dhabi, Sharjah or the northern emirates follow their own authority's rules.